

French cuisine

French cuisine is the cooking traditions and practices of France. In the 14th century, Guillaume Tirel, a court chef known as "Taillevent", wrote *Le Viandier*, one of the earliest recipe collections of medieval France. In the 17th and 18th centuries, chefs François Pierre La Varenne and Marie-Antoine Carême spearheaded movements that shifted French cooking away from its foreign influences such as from Italian cuisine and developed France's own indigenous style.^[1]

Cheese and wine are a major part of the cuisine. They play different roles regionally and nationally, with many variations and *appellation d'origine contrôlée* (AOC) (regulated appellation) laws.^[2]

Culinary tourism and the *Guide Michelin* helped to acquaint commoners with the *cuisine bourgeoise* of the urban elites and the peasant cuisine of the French countryside starting in the 20th century. Many dishes that were once regional have proliferated in variations across the country.

Knowledge of French cooking has contributed significantly to Western cuisines. Its criteria are used widely in Western cookery school boards and culinary education. In November 2010, French gastronomy was added by the UNESCO to its lists of the world's "intangible cultural heritage".^{[3][4]}

History

Middle Ages

In French medieval cuisine, banquets were common among the aristocracy. Multiple courses would be prepared, but served in a style called *service en confusion*, or all at once. Food was generally eaten by hand, meats being sliced off in large pieces held between the thumb and two fingers. The sauces were highly seasoned and thick, and heavily flavored mustards were used.

Pies were a common banquet item, with the crust serving primarily as a container, rather than as food itself, and it was not until the very end of the Late Middle Ages that the shortcrust pie was developed.



A *nouvelle cuisine* presentation 



French *haute cuisine* presentation 



French wines are usually made to accompany French cuisine. 

Meals often ended with an *issue de table*, which later changed into the modern dessert, and typically consisted of *dragées* (in the Middle Ages, meaning spiced lumps of hardened sugar or honey), aged cheese, and spiced wine, such as *hypocras*.^{[5]:1–7}

The ingredients of the time varied greatly according to the seasons and the church calendar, and many items were preserved with salt, spices, honey, and other preservatives. Late spring, summer, and autumn afforded abundance, while winter meals were more sparse. Livestock were slaughtered at the beginning of winter. Beef was often salted, while pork was salted and smoked. Bacon and sausages would be smoked in the chimney, while the tongue and hams were brined and dried. Cucumbers were brined as well, while greens would be packed in jars with salt. Fruits, nuts and root vegetables would be boiled in honey for preservation. Whale, dolphin and porpoise were considered fish, so during Lent, the salted meats of these sea mammals were eaten.^{[5]:9–12}

Artificial freshwater ponds (often called *stews*) held carp, pike, tench, breem, eel, and other fish. Poultry was kept in special yards, with pigeon and squab being reserved for the elite. Game was highly prized, but very rare, and included venison, boar, hare, rabbit, and fowl.

Kitchen gardens provided herbs, including some, such as tansy, rue, pennyroyal, and hyssop, which are rarely used today. Spices were treasured and very expensive at that time—they included pepper, cinnamon, cloves, nutmeg, and mace. Some spices used then, but no longer today in French cuisine are cubebs, long pepper (both from vines similar to black pepper), grains of paradise, and galengale.

Sweet-sour flavors were commonly added to dishes with vinegar and verjus combined with sugar (for the affluent) or honey. A common form of food preparation was to thoroughly cook, pound, and strain mixtures into fine pastes and mushes, something believed to be beneficial to make use of nutrients.^{[5]:13–15}

Visual display was prized. Brilliant colors were obtained by the addition of, for example, juices from spinach and the green part of leeks. Yellow came from saffron or egg yolk, while red came from sunflower (after the Columbian Exchange), and purple came from Crozophora tinctoria or Heliotropium europaeum.

Gold and silver leaf were placed on food surfaces and brushed with egg whites. Elaborate and showy dishes were the result, such as *tourte parmerienne* which was a pastry dish made to look like a castle with chicken-drumstick turrets coated with gold leaf. One of the grandest showpieces of the time was a roast swan or peacock sewn back into its skin with feathers intact, the feet and beak being gilded.^{[5]:15–16}



John, Duke of Berry enjoying a grand meal. The Duke is sitting with a cardinal at the high table, under a luxurious *baldaquin*, in front of the fireplace, tended to by several servants, including a carver. On the table to the left of the Duke is a golden salt cellar, or *nef*, in the shape of a ship; illustration from *Très Riches Heures du Duc de Berry*, circa 1410.

The most well-known French chef of the Middle Ages was Guillaume Tirel, also known as Taillevent. Taillevent worked in numerous royal kitchens during the 14th century. His first position was as a kitchen boy in 1326. He was chef to Philip VI, then the Dauphin who was son of John II. The Dauphin became King Charles V of France in 1364, with Taillevent as his chief cook. His career spanned sixty-six years, and upon his death, he was buried in grand style between his two wives. His tombstone represents him in armor, holding a shield with three cooking pots, *marmites*, on it.^{[5]:18–21}

Ancient Régime

Paris was the central hub of culture and economic activity, and as such, the most highly skilled culinary craftsmen were to be found there. Markets in Paris such as Les Halles, la Mégisserie, those found along Rue Mouffetard, and similar smaller versions in other cities were very important to the distribution of food. Those that gave French produce its characteristic identity were regulated by the guild system, which developed in the Middle Ages. In Paris, the guilds were regulated by city government as well as by the French crown. A guild restricted those in a given branch of the culinary industry to operate only within that field.^{[5]:71–72}

There were two groups of guilds—first, those that supplied the raw materials: butchers, fishmongers, grain merchants, and gardeners. The second group were those that supplied prepared foods: bakers, pastry cooks, sauce makers, poulterers, and caterers. Some guilds offered both raw materials and prepared food, such as the charcutiers and rôtisseurs (purveyors of roasted meat dishes). They would supply cooked meat pies and dishes as well as raw meat and poultry. This caused issues with butchers and poulterers, who sold the same raw materials.^{[5]:72–73}

The guilds served as a training ground for those within the industry. The degrees of assistant cook, full-fledged cook and master chef were conferred. Those who reached the level of master chef were of considerable rank in their individual industry, and enjoyed a high level of income as well as economic and job security. At times, those in the royal kitchens did fall under the guild hierarchy, but it was necessary to find them a parallel appointment based on their skills after leaving the service of the royal kitchens. This was not uncommon as the Paris cooks' Guild regulations allowed for this movement.^{[5]:73}

During the 16th and 17th centuries, French cuisine assimilated many new food items from the New World. Although they were slow to be adopted, records of banquets show Catherine de' Medici serving sixty-six turkeys at one dinner.^{[5]:81} The dish called cassoulet has its roots in the New World discovery of haricot beans, which are central to the dish's creation, but had not existed outside of the Americas until the arrival of Europeans.^{[5]:85}

Haute cuisine (pronounced [ot kɥizin], "high cuisine") has foundations during the 17th century with a chef named La Varenne. As an author of works such as *Le Cuisinier françois*, he is credited with publishing the first true French cookbook. His book includes the earliest known reference to roux using pork fat. The book contained two sections, one for meat days, and one for fasting. His recipes marked a change from the style of cookery known in the Middle Ages to new techniques aimed at creating somewhat lighter dishes, and more modest presentations of pies as individual pastries and turnovers. La Varenne also published a book on pastry in 1667 entitled *Le Parfait confitvriier* (republished as *Le Confiturier françois*) which similarly updated and codified the emerging *haute cuisine* standards for desserts and pastries.^{[5]:114–120}

Chef François Massialot wrote *Le Cuisinier roïal et bourgeois* in 1691, during the reign of Louis XIV. The book contains menus served to the royal courts in 1690. Massialot worked mostly as a freelance cook, and was not employed by any particular household. Massialot and many other royal cooks received special privileges by association with the French royalty. They were not subject to the regulation of the guilds; therefore, they could cater weddings and banquets without restriction. His book is the first to list recipes alphabetically, perhaps a forerunner of the first culinary dictionary. It is in this book that a marinade is first seen in print, with one type for poultry and feathered game, while a second is for fish and shellfish. No quantities are listed in the recipes, which suggests that Massialot was writing for trained cooks.^{[5]:149–154}

The successive updates of *Le Cuisinier roïal et bourgeois* include important refinements such as adding a glass of wine to fish stock. Definitions were also added to the 1703 edition. The 1712 edition, retitled *Le Nouveau cuisinier royal et bourgeois*, was increased to two volumes, and was written in a more elaborate style with extensive explanations of technique. Additional smaller preparations are included in this edition as well, leading to lighter preparations, and adding a third course to the meal. Ragout, a stew still central to French cookery, makes its first appearance as a single dish in this edition as well; prior to that, it was listed as a garnish.^{[5]:155}

Late 18th century – early 19th century

Shortly before the French Revolution, dishes like bouchées à la Reine gained prominence. Essentially royal cuisine produced by the royal household, this is a chicken-based recipe served on vol-au-vent created under the influence of Queen Marie Leszczyńska, the Polish-born wife of Louis XV. This recipe is still popular today, as are other recipes from Queen Marie Leszczyńska like consommé à la Reine and filet d'aloyau braisé à la royale. Queen Marie is also credited with introducing Polonaise garnishing to the French diet.

The French Revolution was integral to the expansion of French cuisine, because it abolished the guild system. This meant anyone could now produce and sell any culinary item they wished.

Bread was a significant food source among peasants and the working class in the late 18th century, with many of the nation's people being dependent on it. In French provinces, bread was often consumed three times a day by the people of France.^[6] According to Brace, bread was referred to as the basic dietary item for the masses, and it was also used as a foundation for soup. In fact, bread was so important that harvest, interruption of commerce by wars, heavy flour exploration, and prices and supply were all watched and controlled by the French Government. Among the underprivileged, constant fear of famine was always prevalent. From 1725 to 1789, there were fourteen years of bad yields to blame for the low grain supply. In Bordeaux, during 1708–1789, thirty-three bad harvests occurred.^[6]



The Polish wife of Louis XV, Queen Marie Leszczyńska, influenced French cuisine. 

Marie-Antoine Carême was born in 1784, five years before the Revolution. He spent his younger years working at a pâtisserie until he was discovered by Charles Maurice de Talleyrand-Périgord; he would later cook for Napoleon. Prior to his employment with Talleyrand, Carême had become known for his pièces montées, which were extravagant constructions of pastry and sugar architecture.^{[7]:144–145}

More important to Carême's career was his contribution to the refinement of French cuisine. The basis for his style of cooking was his sauces, which he named mother sauces. Often referred to as fonds, meaning "foundations", these base sauces, espagnole, velouté, and béchamel, are still known today. Each of these sauces was made in large quantities in his kitchen, then formed the basis of multiple derivatives. Carême had over one hundred sauces in his repertoire.

In his writings, soufflés appear for the first time. Although many of his preparations today seem extravagant, he simplified and codified an even more complex cuisine that existed beforehand. Central to his codification of the cuisine were *Le Maître d'hôtel français* (1822), *Le Cuisinier parisien* (1828) and *L'Art de la cuisine française au dix-neuvième siècle* (1833–5).^{[7]:144–148}

Late 19th century – early 20th century

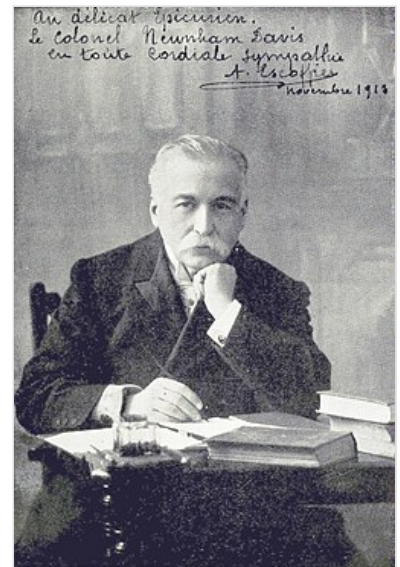
Georges Auguste Escoffier is commonly acknowledged as the central figure to the modernization of *haute cuisine* and organizing what became the national cuisine of France. His influence began with the rise of some of the great hotels in Europe and America during the 1880s–1890s. The Savoy Hotel, managed by César Ritz, was an early hotel in which Escoffier worked, but much of his influence came during his management of the kitchens in the Carlton from 1898 until 1921. He created a system of "parties" called the brigade system, which separated the professional kitchen into five separate stations.

These five stations included the garde manger that prepared cold dishes; the entremettier, which prepared starches and vegetables; the rôtisseur, which prepared roasts, grilled and fried dishes; the saucier, which prepared sauces and soups; and the pâtissier, preparing all pastry and desserts items.

This system meant that instead of one person preparing a dish on one's own, multiple cooks would prepare the different components for the dish. An example used is *oeufs au plat Meyerbeer*; under the prior system, the dish would take up to fifteen minutes to prepare, while in the new system, the eggs would be prepared by the *entremettier*, kidney grilled by the *rôtisseur*, and truffle sauce made by the *saucier*, and thus the dish could be prepared in a shorter time and served quickly.^{[7]:157–159}



Marie-Antoine Carême was a French chef and an early practitioner and exponent of the elaborate style of cooking known as grande cuisine



Georges Auguste Escoffier was a French chef, restaurateur, and culinary writer who popularized and updated traditional French cooking methods

Escoffier also simplified and organized the modern menu and structure of the meal. He published a series of articles in professional journals which outlined the sequence, and he finally published his *Livre des menus* in 1912. This type of service embraced the *service à la russe* (serving meals in separate courses on individual plates), which Félix Urbain Dubois had made popular in the 1860s. Escoffier's largest contribution was the publication of *Le Guide Culinaire* in 1903, which established the fundamentals of French cookery. The book was a collaboration with Philéas Gilbert, E. Fétu, A. Suzanne, B. Reboul, Ch. Dietrich, A. Caillat and others. The significance of this is to illustrate the universal acceptance by multiple high-profile chefs to this new style of cooking.^{[7]:159–160}

Le Guide Culinaire deemphasized the use of heavy sauces and leaned toward lighter *fumets*, which are the essence of flavor taken from fish, meat and vegetables. This style of cooking looked to create garnishes and sauces whose function is to add to the flavor of the dish, rather than mask flavors like the heavy sauces and ornate garnishes of the past. Escoffier took inspiration for his work from personal recipes in addition to recipes from Carême, Dubois and ideas from Taillevent's *Le Viandier*, a modern version of which was published in 1897. A second source for recipes came from existing peasant dishes that were translated into the refined techniques of *haute cuisine*.

The third source of recipes was Escoffier himself, who invented many new dishes, such as *pêche Melba*.^{[7]:160–162} Escoffier updated *Le Guide Culinaire* four times during his lifetime, noting in the foreword to the book's first edition that even with its 5,000 recipes, the book should not be considered an "exhaustive" text, and that even if it were at the point when he wrote the book, "it would no longer be so tomorrow, because progress marches on each day."^[8]

This period is also marked by the appearance of *nouvelle cuisine*. The term "nouvelle cuisine" has been used many times in the history of French cuisine which emphasized the freshness, lightness and clarity of flavor and inspired by new movements in world cuisine. In the 1740s, Menon first used the term, but the cooking of Vincent La Chapelle and François Marin was also considered modern. In the 1960s, Henri Gault and Christian Millau revived it to describe the cooking of Paul Bocuse, Jean and Pierre Troisgros, Michel Guérard, Roger Vergé and Raymond Oliver.^[9] These chefs were working toward rebelling against the "orthodoxy" of Escoffier's cuisine. Some of the chefs were students of Fernand Point at the *Pyramide* in Vienne, and had left to open their own restaurants. Gault and Millau "discovered the formula" contained in ten characteristics of this new style of cooking.^{[7]:163–164} Those characteristics were:

1. A rejection of excessive complication in cooking.
2. The cooking times for most fish, seafood, game birds, veal, green vegetables and *pâtés* were greatly reduced in an attempt to preserve the natural flavors. Steaming was an important trend emerging from this characteristic.
3. The cuisine was made with the freshest possible ingredients.
4. Large menus were abandoned in favor of shorter menus.
5. Strong marinades for meat and game ceased to be used.^{[7]:163–164}
6. They stopped using heavy sauces such as *espagnole* and *béchamel* thickened with flour-based *roux* in favor of seasoning their dishes with fresh herbs, quality butter, lemon juice, and vinegar.
7. They used regional dishes for inspiration instead of *haute cuisine* dishes.

8. New techniques were embraced and modern equipment was often used; Bocuse even used microwave ovens.
9. The chefs paid close attention to the dietary needs of their guests through their dishes.
10. The chefs were highly innovative and created new combinations and pairings.^[7]:163–164

Some have speculated that a contributor to the emergence of *nouvelle cuisine* was World War II, when animal protein was in short supply during the German occupation.^[10] By the mid-1980s, food writers stated that *nouvelle cuisine* had reached exhaustion and many chefs began returning to the *haute cuisine* style of cooking, although many of the lighter presentations and new techniques remained.^[7]:163–164

Contemporary cuisine

French cuisine continues to change and adapt. In the contemporary period. "La Bistronomie" describing a fusion of bistro and haute cuisine emerged alongside new popular foods such as the French taco, new styles of food including food trucks, growing interest in vegetarian food and increased vegetarian options, and a public interest in simpler dining options.^{[11][12][13][14]} These changes are alongside the incorporation and mainstreaming of dishes from immigrant communities in part shaped by immigration and global exchange.^[12] Culinary influences are especially strong from across the Francophone world and beyond, including North African cuisines (notably couscous, which is often cited as one of modern France's most widely consumed dishes), Lebanese cuisine (with foods like falafel becoming widely popular), Southeast Asian traditions from countries such as Vietnam and Cambodia (including pho and banh mi), and a growing presence of African cuisines and spices in everyday French cooking.^{[15][16][17]} This transformation is tied to the French restaurant workforce with immigrants playing a major role in French commercial kitchens. Estimates suggest roughly twenty-five percent of chefs in France are immigrants, and in Paris about half of chefs are immigrants.^[18] France also continues to attract international chefs to train, who either stay in France or return to their home countries after learning French techniques.^[19]

National cuisine

There are many dishes that are considered part of French national cuisine today.

A meal often consists of three courses, *hors d'œuvre* or *entrée* (introductory course, sometimes soup), *plat principal* (main course), *fromage* (cheese course) or *dessert*, sometimes with a salad offered before the cheese or dessert.

The notion of a French national cuisine is understood as a set of foods that all people eat and have strong opinions about, regardless of class. Those who are poorer still eat the same foods as the rich, albeit less frequently.^[20]

Hors d'œuvre



Basil salmon terrine



Bisque is a smooth and creamy French potage.



Foie gras with mustard seeds and green onions in duck jus

Plat principal



Pot-au-feu is a cuisine classique dish.



Blanquette de veau

Pâtisserie



Typical French pâtisserie



Mille-feuille



Macaron

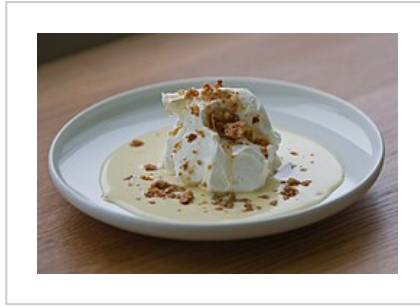


Éclair

Dessert



Crêpe



île flottante

Regional cuisine

French regional cuisine is characterized by its extreme diversity and style. Traditionally, each region of France has its own distinctive cuisine.^[21]

Paris and Île-de-France

Paris and Île-de-France are central regions where almost anything from the country is available, as all train lines meet in the city. Over 9,000 restaurants exist in Paris and almost any cuisine can be obtained here. High-quality Michelin Guide-rated restaurants proliferate here.^[22]

Champagne, Lorraine, and Alsace

Game and ham are popular in Champagne, as well as the special sparkling wine simply known as Champagne. Fine fruit preserves are known from Lorraine as well as the quiche Lorraine.^[23] Alsace, a region of historically Alлемanic German culture, has retained elements of German cuisine, especially similar to those from the neighboring Palatinate and Baden region, but has implemented French influences since France first took control of the region in the 17th century. As such, beers made in the area are similar to the style of bordering Germany. Dishes like choucroute (French for sauerkraut) are also popular.^{[22]:55} Many eaux de vie (distilled alcohol from fruit, comparable to schnaps) are from this region, due to a wide variety of local fruits (cherry, raspberry, pear, grapes) and especially prunes (mirabelle, plum).[9]:259,295



The 22 regions and 96 departments of metropolitan France (pre-2016 reforms) include Corsica (*Corse*, lower right). Paris area is expanded (inset at left).



Flûte of Champagne wine



Alsatian Flammekueche



Quiche



Choucroute garnie



Andouillette

Nord Pas-de-Calais, Picardy, Normandy, and Brittany

The coastline supplies many crustaceans, sea bass, monkfish and herring. Normandy has top-quality seafood, such as scallops and sole, while Brittany has a supply of lobster, crayfish and mussels.

Normandy is home to a large population of apple trees; apples are often used in dishes, as well as cider and Calvados. The northern areas of this region, especially Nord, grow ample amounts of wheat, sugar beets and chicory. Thick stews are found often in these northern areas as well.

The produce of these northern regions is also considered some of the best in the country, including cauliflower and artichokes. Buckwheat grows widely in Brittany as well and is used in the region's galettes, called jalet, which is where this dish originated.^{[22]:93}



"Carte Gastronomique de la France" belong to the outset of the "Cours Gastronomique" by Charles Louis Cadet de Gassicourt (1809).



Scallops served with a mixed salad in a French restaurant



Crème Chantilly, created at the Château de Chantilly.



Camembert, cheese specialty from Normandy



Crêpe and cider, specialties of Brittany



Lille waffles



Belon oysters

Loire Valley and central France

High-quality fruits come from the Loire Valley and central France, including cherries grown for the liqueur Guignolet and Belle Angevine pears. The strawberries and melons are also of high quality.

Fish are seen in the cuisine, often served with a beurre blanc sauce, as well as wild game, lamb, calves, Charolais cattle, Géline fowl, and goat cheeses.

Young vegetables are used often, as are the specialty mushrooms of the region, champignons de Paris. Vinegars from Orléans are a specialty ingredient used as well. [22]:129,132

Burgundy and Franche-Comté

Burgundy and Franche-Comté are known for their wines. Pike, perch, river crabs, snails, game, redcurrants, blackcurrants all originate here.

Savory specialties accounted in the *Cuisine franc-comtoise* from the Franche-Comté region are croûte aux morilles, Poulet à la Comtoise, trout, smoked meats and cheeses such as Mont d'Or, Comté and Morbier which are best eaten hot or cold, coq au vin jaune and the special dessert gâteau de ménage.

Charolais beef, poultry from Bresse, sea snail, honey cake, Chaource and Époisses cheese are specialties of the local cuisine of Burgundy. Dijon mustard is also a specialty of Burgundy cuisine. Crème de cassis is a popular liquor made from blackcurrants. Oils are used in the cooking here, including nut oils and rapeseed oil. [22]:153,156,166,185



Bœuf bourguignon



Coq au vin



Escargots, with special tongs and fork



Beaujolais wine



Dijon mustard



Comté cheese and vin jaune



Gâteau de ménage

Auvergne-Rhône-Alpes

The area covers the old province of Dauphiné, once known as the "larder" of France, that gave its name to gratin dauphinois,^[24] traditionally made in a large baking dish rubbed with garlic. Successive layers of potatoes, salt, pepper and milk are piled up to the top of the dish. It is then baked in the oven at low temperature for 2 hours.^[25]

Fruit and young vegetables are popular in the cuisine from the Rhône valley, as are wines like Hermitage AOC, Crozes-Hermitage AOC and Condrieu AOC. Walnuts and walnut products and oil from Noix de Grenoble AOC, lowland cheeses, like St. Marcellin, St. Félicien and Bleu du Vercors-Sassenage.

Poultry from Bresse, guinea fowl from Drôme and fish from the Dombes, a light yeast-based cake, called Pogne de Romans and the regional speciality, Raviole du Dauphiné, and there is the short-crust "Suisse", a Valence biscuit speciality.



Grand sechoir,
Museum of the Walnut in
Vinay, Isère

Lakes and mountain streams in Rhône-Alpes are key to the cuisine as well. Lyon and Savoy supply sausages while the Alpine regions supply their specialty cheeses like Beaufort, Abondance, Reblochon, Tomme and Vacherin.^{[26][27][28][29]}

Mères lyonnaises are female cooks particular to this region who provide local gourmet establishments.^[30] Celebrated chefs from this region include Fernand Point, Paul Bocuse, the Troisgros brothers and Alain Chapel.^[31]

The Chartreuse Mountains are the source of the green and yellow digestif liquor Chartreuse, produced by the monks of the Grande Chartreuse.^{[22]:197,230}

Since the 2014 administrative reform, the ancient area of Auvergne is now part of the region. One of its leading chefs is Regis Marcon.



Salade lyonnaise



Drome apricots



Gratin dauphinois



Bleu du Vercors-Sassenage



Sweet chestnuts



Chartreuse Elixir Végétal



Salade de ravioles



Condrieu wine



Suisse de Valence biscuit



Bleu de Bresse



Poulet de Bresse chicken salad



Rosette de Lyon charcuterie



Noix de Grenoble, unusual
trilaterally symmetric walnut



Beaufort cheeses ripening in a
cellar

Poitou-Charentes and Limousin

Oysters come from the Oléron-Marennes basin, while mussels come from the Bay of Aiguillon.

High-quality produce comes from the region's hinterland, especially goat cheese. This region and in the Vendée is grazing ground for *Parthenaise* cattle, while poultry is raised in Challans.

The region of Poitou-Charentes purportedly produces the best butter and cream in France. Cognac is also made in the region along the river Charente.

Limousin is home to the Limousin cattle, as well as sheep. The woodlands offer game and mushrooms. The southern area around Brive draws its cooking influence from Périgord and Auvergne to produce a robust cuisine.^{[22]:237}

Bordeaux, Périgord, Gascony, and Basque country

Bordeaux, a renowned French city, lends its name to a distinctive wine style celebrated worldwide.^[32] Bordeaux, along with the larger Aquitaine region, ranks among the top three wine destinations globally, alongside Napa Valley and Tuscany. Saint-Emilion, a UNESCO World Heritage village, is a key destination, drawing a multitude of wine tourists to the region.^[32]

Bordeaux's diverse viticultural regions specialize in a range of grape varieties such as Merlot, Cabernet Franc, and increasingly Cabernet Sauvignon, each thriving in the picturesque landscapes of the area.^[33] This variety contributes significantly to the region's rich viticultural diversity and the production of wines of strong quality.^[33]

Building on this agricultural foundation, Bordeaux wine offers a rich history, varied terroir, and complex flavor profile, making it highly versatile for food pairing across various cuisines and occasions.^[34] Traditional Bordeaux blends typically include the aforementioned Cabernet Sauvignon, Merlot, and Cabernet Franc, providing a spectrum of flavors and textures that complement a wide array of dishes.^[34]

Lighter wines like Bordeaux Blanc or a light-bodied Bordeaux Rouge can elegantly accompany seafood or poultry. The crisp acidity and citrus notes of Bordeaux Blanc complement delicate seafood dishes like grilled fish or shrimp cocktail, while the soft tannins of a light Bordeaux Rouge enhance the flavors of roasted chicken or turkey.^[34] Moreover, Bordeaux Rouge wines pair beautifully with dishes like roasted lamb, duck breast, or vegetable stews. The wine's balanced fruitiness and moderate tannins complement the richness of the proteins without overpowering the palate.^[34]

Meanwhile, more robust Bordeaux Rouge wines, particularly from renowned appellations like Saint-Émilion, are perfect for richer, savory dishes such as grilled steak or braised beef, where their intense fruit flavors and firm tannins provide a balanced counterpoint to the umami-rich flavors.^[34] Understanding this interplay of flavors allows diners to elevate their culinary experiences, creating memorable pairings with Bordeaux wines.^[34]

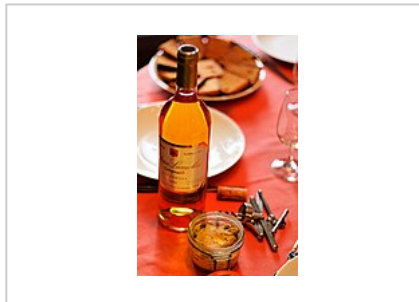
The Pyrenees also has lamb, such as the Agneau de Pauillac, as well as sheep cheeses. Beef cattle in the region include the Blonde d'Aquitaine, Boeuf de Chalosse, Boeuf Gras de Bazas, and Garonnaise.

Free-range chicken, turkey, pigeon, capon, goose and duck prevail in the region as well. Gascony and Périgord cuisines includes pâtés, terrines, confits and magrets. This is one of the regions notable for its production of foie gras, or fattened goose or duck liver.

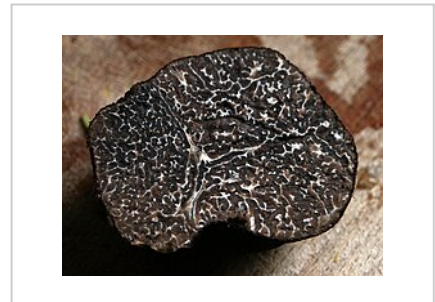
The cuisine of the region is often heavy and farm-based. Armagnac is also from this region, as are prunes from Agen.^{[22]:259,295}



Confit de canard



A terrine of foie gras with a bottle of Sauternes



Black Périgord truffle



Tourin, a garlic soup from Dordogne

Toulouse, Quercy, and Aveyron

Gers, a department of France, is within this region and has poultry, while La Montagne Noire and Lacaune area offer hams and dry sausages.

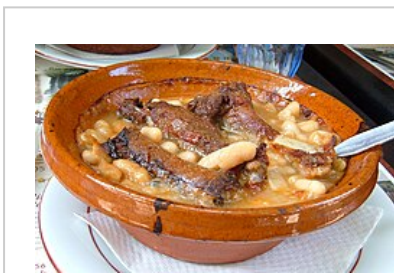
White corn is planted heavily in the area both for use in fattening ducks and geese for foie gras and for the production of millas, a cornmeal porridge. Haricot beans are also grown in this area, which are central to the dish cassoulet.

The finest sausage in France is saucisse de Toulouse, which is also part of cassoulet of Toulouse. The Cahors area produces a specialty "black wine" as well as truffles and mushrooms.

This region also produces milk-fed lamb. Unpasteurized ewe's milk is used to produce Roquefort in Aveyron, while in Laguiole is producing unpasteurized cow's milk cheese. Salers cattle produce milk for cheese, as well as beef and veal products.

The volcanic soils create flinty cheeses and superb lentils. Mineral waters are produced in high volume in this region as well.^{[22]:313} Cabécou cheese is from Rocamadour, a medieval settlement erected directly on a cliff, in the rich countryside of Causses du Quercy.

This area is one of the region's oldest milk producers; it has chalky soil, marked by history and human activity, and is favourable for the raising of goats.



Cassoulet



Aligot



Roquefort cheese

Roussillon, Languedoc, and Cévennes

Restaurants are popular in the area known as Le Midi. Oysters come from the Étang de Thau, to be served in the restaurants of Bouzigues, Mèze, and Sète. Mussels are commonly seen here in addition to fish specialties of Sète, bourride, tielles and rouille de seiche.

In the Languedoc jambon cru, sometimes known as jambon de montagne is produced. High quality Roquefort comes from the brebis (sheep) on the Larzac plateau.

The Cévennes area offers mushrooms, chestnuts, berries, honey, lamb, game, sausages, pâtés and goat cheeses. Catalan influence can be seen in the cuisine here with dishes like brandade made from a purée of dried cod wrapped in mangold leaves. Snails are plentiful and are prepared in a specific Catalan style known as a cargolade. Wild boar can be found in the more mountainous regions of the Midi.^{[22]:349,360}

Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur

The Provence and Côte d'Azur region is rich in citrus, vegetables, fruits and herbs; the region is one of the largest suppliers of all these ingredients in France. The region also produces the largest amount of olives, and creates high-quality olive oil. Lavender is used in many dishes in Haute-Provence. Other important herbs in the cuisine include thyme, sage, rosemary, basil, savory, fennel, marjoram, tarragon, oregano, and bay leaf.^[35] Honey is a prized ingredient in the region.



Fresh vegetables displayed for sale at an outdoor market in France 

Seafood is widely available throughout the coastal area and is heavily represented in the cuisine. Goat cheeses, air-dried sausages, lamb, beef, and chicken are popular here. Garlic and anchovies are used in many of the region's sauces, as in *poulet Provençal*, which uses white wine, tomatoes, herbs, and sometimes anchovies. Pastis is found everywhere that alcohol is served.

The cuisine uses a large amount of vegetables for lighter preparations. Truffles are commonly seen in Provence during the winter. Thirteen desserts in Provence are the traditional Christmas dessert,^[36] and may include, for example, quince cheese, biscuits, almonds, nougat, apple, and fougasse.

Rice is grown in the Camargue, which is the northernmost rice-growing area in Europe, with Camargue red rice being a specialty.^{[22]:387,403,404,410,416} Anibal Camous, a Marseillais who lived to be 104, maintained that it was by eating garlic daily that he kept his "youth" and brilliance. When his eighty-year-old son died, the father mourned, "I always told him he wouldn't live long, poor boy. He ate too little garlic!"



Ratatouille



Salade niçoise



Bouillabaisse



Daube



Pissaladière



Pan bagnat



Vacqueyras wine



Bourride de fruits de mer



Salade mesclun



Pieds paquets

Corsica

Goats and sheep proliferate on the island of Corsica, and lamb are used to prepare dishes such as stufato, ragouts and roasts. Cheeses are also produced, with brocciu being the most popular.

Chestnuts, growing in the Castagniccia forest, are used to produce flour, which is used in turn to make bread, cakes and polenta. The forest provides acorns used to feed the pigs and boars that provide much of the protein for the island's cuisine. Fresh fish and seafood are common.

The island's pork is used to make fine hams, sausage and other unique items including coppa (dried rib cut), lonzu (dried pork fillet), figatellu (smoked and dried liverwurst), salumu (a dried sausage), salcietta, Panzetta, bacon, and prisuttu (farmer's ham).

Clementines (which hold an AOC designation), lemons, nectarines and figs are grown there. Candied citron is used in nougats, while and the aforementioned brocciu and chestnuts are also used in desserts.

Corsica offers a variety of wines and fruit liqueurs, including Cap Corse, Patrimonio, Cédratine, Bonapartine, liqueur de myrte, vins de fruit, Rappu, and eau-de-vie de châtaigne.^{[22]:435,441,442}

French Guiana

French Guianan cuisine or **Guianan cuisine** is a blend of the different cultures that have settled in French Guiana including European, Indian, Indigenous (Amerindian), Chinese, and Hmong influences.^{[37][38]} Common dishes include fricassés, stews made of awara broth (made from palm pulp), blaff (onions, garlic, celery and basil broth), pimentade (tomato sauce broth) or roast cougnade (grilled fish), and Colombos (meat-based stew and vegetables with curry).^{[39][38]} There are markets in Cayenne selling fresh and prepared foods among other items.^[40] Some dishes from Metropolitan France are reimagined using local ingredients such as Gratin de Couac using cassava root in lieu of potato.^[41]



Achards de légumes



Colombo de poulet



Fricassée de bœuf au riz créole

Réunion

The cuisine of Réunion is a Creole cuisine (in French, *Créole*) with a mixture of cooking styles and ingredients. It is strongly influenced by Malagasy cuisine (from Madagascar), as well as other cuisines from East Africa. It also incorporates elements of larger French, Indian and Chinese cuisines, brought by French colonialization and Indian and Chinese immigrants respectively.^{[42][43]} Notable dishes include samosas, bouchons, rougail, and various curries.^[44]



Rougail saucisse



Somasa



Saladier de rougail

Martinique

The cuisine of Martinique is a Creole cuisine with a mix of French, indigenous, African, and Indian cooking styles using local ingredients such as breadfruit, cassava, and christophene.^[45] Creole dishes rely heavily on seafood, including curries and fritters. Crêperies, Brasseries, and restaurants featuring cuisine from various French regions can be found all over Martinique.^[45] Notable local dishes include Accra a fish-based fritter, Boudin sausage, Fricassée de chatrou an octopus stew, Colombo de Martinique a coconut-milk based curry, and Ti Punch a rum and cane juice based drink.^[46]

Guadeloupe

The cuisine of Guadeloupe includes Caribbean, African, European and Indian influences. Notable dishes includes the fish fritter accra, a savory stuffed donut called bokit, and coconut-based desserts like custard and sorbet.^[47] Notably. the spice blend "colombo" or "massalé" is a curry-like mix of pepper, saffron, coriander, cumin and garlic with the flavor profile included by Sri Lankan immigrants.^{[47][48]} The island is also known for rums and includes nine distilleries producing traditional and agricultural rum.^[48]

New Caledonia

The cuisine of New Caledonia includes local Kanak, Melanesian, and traditional French cooking styles.^[49] A notable local dish is bougna which is a stew composed of starches, taros, sweet potatoes, *poingo* bananas, yams, and is accompanied by local meat and cooked in coconut milk.^[50] Seafood is also common including fish and lobster.^[51] Traditional French pastries, breads, cheeses, and wines may also be found especially in the capital of Nouméa.^[49]



Bougna



Travail du coco par une femme Kanak

French Polynesia

The cuisine of French Polynesia includes a significant array of fruits and vegetables especially sweet potato and coconut.^[52] Due to the island nature of the region, seafood is also very common.^[53] The "*ahima'a*", is a traditional Polynesian underground oven in which hot stones are placed inside to cook the ingredients.^[53] Notable dishes include Faraoa 'ipo, Poisson cru and Rēti'a.

Mayotte

The cuisine of Mayotte includes influences from European France, Portugal, the Arab world, and India.^[54] Common food includes rice as a daily staple mixed with root vegetables, plantains, fresh and dried fish, and milk from grated coconuts and meat. Notable dishes include *Chahoula ya nadzi*, rice boiled in water or coconut milk generally served for large meals and *makarara* a festive fried cake that is prepared into rolls of dough made of flour and coconut milk.^{[55][56]}



Pilao



Romazava

Specialties by season

French cuisine varies according to the season. In summer, salads and fruit dishes are popular because they are refreshing and produce is inexpensive and abundant. Greengrocers prefer to sell their fruits and vegetables at lower prices if needed, rather than see them rot in the heat. At the end of summer, mushrooms become plentiful and appear in stews throughout France. The hunting season begins in September and runs through February. Game of all kinds is eaten, often in elaborate dishes that celebrate the success of the hunt. Shellfish are at their peak when winter turns to spring, and oysters appear in restaurants in large quantities.

With the advent of deep-freeze and the air-conditioned *hypermarché*, these seasonal variations are less marked than before, but they are still observed, in some cases due to legal restrictions. Crayfish, for example, have a short season and it is illegal to catch them out of season.^[57] Moreover, they do not freeze well.

Foods and ingredients

French regional cuisines use locally grown vegetables, such as *pomme de terre* (potato), *blé* (wheat), *haricots verts* (a type of French green bean), *carotte* (carrot), *poireau* (leek), *navet* (turnip), *aubergine* (eggplant), *courgette* (zucchini), and *échalotte* (shallot).

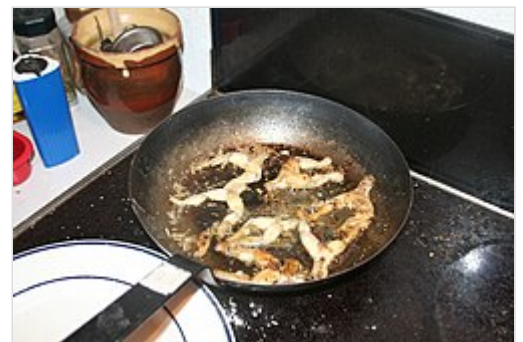
French regional cuisines use locally grown fungi, such as *truffe* (truffle), *champignon de Paris* (button mushroom), *chanterelle ou girolle* (chanterelle), *pleurote (en huître)* (oyster mushrooms), and *cèpes* (porcini).

Common fruits include oranges, tomatoes, tangerines, peaches, apricots, apples, pears, plums, cherries, strawberries, raspberries, redcurrants, blackberries, grapes, grapefruit, and blackcurrants.

Varieties of meat consumed include *poulet* (chicken), *pigeon* (squab), *canard* (duck), *oie* (goose, the source of foie gras), *bœuf* (beef), *veau* (veal), *porc* (pork), *agneau* (lamb), *mouton* (mutton), *caille* (quail), *cheval* (horse), *grenouille* (frog), and *escargot* (snails). Commonly consumed fish and seafood include cod, canned sardines, fresh sardines, canned tuna, fresh tuna, salmon, trout, mussels, herring, oysters, shrimp and calamari.

Eggs often eaten as: omelettes, hard-boiled with mayonnaise, scrambled plain, scrambled *haute cuisine* preparation, œuf à la coque.

Herbs and seasonings vary by region, and include *fleur de sel*, *herbes de Provence*, olive, tarragon, rosemary, marjoram, lavender, thyme, fennel, and sage.



Frog legs frying in a pan in France



Fresh fruit and vegetables, as well as fish and meat, can be purchased either from supermarkets or specialty shops. Street markets are held on certain days in most localities; some towns have a more permanent covered market enclosing food shops, especially meat and fish retailers. These have better shelter than the periodic street markets.



Herbes de provence



Charolais cattle



Champignon de Paris



Haricots verts



Piments d'Espelette



Fleur de sel de Guérande



Grappe de raisin



Poulet de Bresse



Blé (Wheat)



Black Périgord truffle

Structure of meals

Breakfast

Le petit déjeuner (breakfast) is traditionally a quick meal consisting of *tartines* (slices) of French bread with butter and honey or jam (sometimes *brioche*), along with *café au lait* (also called *café crème*), or black coffee, or tea^[58] and rarely hot chicory. Children often drink hot chocolate in bowls or cups along with their breakfasts. *Croissants*, *pain aux raisins* or *pain au chocolat* (also named *chocolatine* in the south-west of France) are mostly included as a weekend treat. Breakfast of some kind is always served in *cafés* opening early in the day.



Café with a *croissant* for breakfast



There are also savoury dishes for breakfast. An example is *le petit déjeuner gaulois* or *petit déjeuner fermier* with the famous long narrow bread slices topped with soft white cheese or boiled ham, called *mouillettes*,^[59] which is dipped in a soft-boiled egg and some fruit juice and hot drink.

Another variation called *le petit déjeuner chasseur*, meant to be very hearty, is served with *pâté* and other *charcuterie* products. A more classy version is called *le petit déjeuner du voyageur*, where delicatessens serve gizzard, bacon, salmon, omelet, or *croque monsieur*, with or without soft-boiled egg and always with the traditional coffee/tea/chocolate along fruits or fruit juice. When the egg is cooked sunny-side over the *croque-monsieur*, it is called a *croque-madame*.

In *Germinal* and other novels, Émile Zola also mentioned the *briquet*: two long bread slices stuffed with butter, cheese and or ham. It can be eaten as a standing/walking breakfast, or meant as a "second" one before lunch.

In the movie *Bienvenue chez les Ch'tis*, Philippe Abrams (Kad Merad) and Antoine Bailleul (Dany Boon) share together countless breakfasts consisting of *tartines de Maroilles* (a strong cheese) along with their hot chicory.

Lunch

Le déjeuner (lunch) is a two-hour mid-day meal or a one-hour lunch break. In some smaller towns and in the south of France, the two-hour lunch may still be customary. Sunday lunches are often longer and are taken with the family.^[60] Restaurants normally open for lunch at noon and close at 2:30 pm. Some restaurants are closed on Monday during lunch hours.^[61]

In large cities, a majority of working people and students eat their lunch at a corporate or school cafeteria, which normally serves complete meals as described above; it is not usual for students to bring their own lunch to eat. For companies that do not operate a cafeteria, it is mandatory for employees to be given lunch vouchers as part of their employee benefits. These can be used in most restaurants, supermarkets and *traiteurs*; however, workers having lunch in this way typically do not eat all three courses of a traditional lunch due to price and time constraints. In smaller cities and towns, some working people leave their workplaces to return home for lunch. An alternative, especially among blue-collar workers, is eating sandwiches followed by a dessert; both dishes can be found ready-made at bakeries and supermarkets at budget prices.

Dinner

Le dîner (dinner) often consists of three courses, hors d'œuvre or entrée (appetizers or introductory course, sometimes soup), plat principal (main course), and a cheese course or dessert, sometimes with a salad offered before the cheese or dessert. Yogurt may replace the cheese course, while a simple dessert would be fresh fruit. The meal is often accompanied by bread, wine and mineral water. Most of the time the bread would be a baguette which is very common in France and is made almost every day. Main meat courses are often served with vegetables, along with potatoes, rice or pasta.^{[60]:82} Restaurants often open at 7:30 pm for dinner, and stop taking orders between the hours of 10:00 pm and 11:00 pm. Some restaurants close for dinner on Sundays.^{[61]:342}

Beverages

In French cuisine, a beverage that precedes a meal is called an apéritif (literally: "that opens the appetite"), and can be served with an amuse-gueule (literally: "mouth amuser"). Those that end it are called digestifs. During the meal, plates are served with water, wine or sometimes beer (*choucroute* and beer, for example).

Apéritifs

The apéritif varies from region to region: Pastis is popular in the south of France, Crémant d'Alsace in the eastern region. Champagne can also be served. Kir, also called *blanc-cassis*, is a common and popular apéritif-cocktail made with a measure of crème de cassis (blackcurrant liqueur) topped up with white wine. The phrase *kir royal* is used when white wine is replaced with a Champagne wine. A simple glass of red wine, such as Beaujolais nouveau, can also be presented as an apéritif, accompanied by an amuse-bouche. Some apéritifs can be fortified wines with added herbs, such as cinchona, gentian and vermouth. Trade names that sell well include Suze (the classic gentiane), Byrrh, Dubonnet, and Noilly Prat. Beer can also be an apéritif. Other drinks are fruit juices or syrups for children.

Digestifs

Digestifs are traditionally stronger, and include Cognac, Armagnac, Calvados, eau de vie and fruit alcohols.

Christmas

A typical French Christmas dish is turkey or capon, with chestnuts. Other common dishes are smoked salmon, oysters, caviar and *foie gras*. The Yule log (*bûche de Noël*) is a very French tradition during Christmas. Chocolate and cakes also occupy a prominent place for Christmas in France. This cuisine is normally accompanied by Champagne. Tradition says that thirteen desserts complete the Christmas meal in reference to the twelve apostles and Christ.^{[62][63][64][65]}

Food establishments

History

The modern restaurant has its origins in French culture. Prior to the late-18th century, diners who wished to "dine out" would visit their local guild-member's kitchen and have their meal prepared for them. However, guild members were limited to producing whatever their guild registry delegated to them.^{[66]:8–10} These guild members offered food in their own homes to a steady clientele that appeared day-to-day but at set times. The guest would be offered the meal *table d'hôte*, which is a meal offered at a set price with very little choice of dishes, sometimes none at all.^{[66]:30–31}

The first steps toward the modern restaurant were locations that offered "restorative" *bouillons*, or *restaurants*—this word being the origin of the term "restaurant". This process took place during the 1760s and 1770s. These locations were open at all times of the day, featuring ornate tableware and reasonable prices. These locations were meant more as meal replacements for those who had "lost their appetites and suffered from jaded palates and weak chests."^{[66]:34–35}

In 1782 Antoine Beauvilliers, pastry chef to the Count of Provence (the future King Louis XVIII), opened one of the most popular restaurants of the time—the *Grande Taverne de Londres*—in the arcades of the Palais-Royal. Other restaurants were opened by chefs of the time who were leaving the failing monarchy of France, in the period leading up to the 1789 French Revolution. It was these restaurants which expanded upon the limited menus of prior decades, and which led to the full restaurants that were completely legalized with the advent of the French Revolution and the abolition of the guilds. This and the substantial discretionary income of the *nouveau riches* of the French Directory period (1795 to 1799) helped to sustain these new restaurants.^{[66]:140–144}



Yule log, a French Christmas tradition 



Cooks at work in Paris 



Restaurant *Le Train Bleu*, in Paris 

Categories

English	French	Description
<u>Restaurant</u>		More than 5,000 in Paris alone, with varying levels of prices and menus. Open at certain times of the day, and normally closed one day of the week. Patrons select items from a printed <u>menu</u> . Some offer regional menus, while others offer a modern-styled menu. Waiters and waitresses are trained and knowledgeable professionals. By law, a <i>prix fixe</i> menu must be offered, although high-class restaurants may try to conceal the fact. Few French restaurants cater to vegetarians. The <i>Guide Michelin</i> rates many of the better restaurants in this category. ^{[22]:30}
<u>Bistro(t)</u>		Generally smaller than a restaurant and often using a chalk-board or verbal menus. Wait-staff may well be untrained. Many feature a regional cuisine. Notable dishes include <i>coq au vin</i> , <i>pot-au-feu</i> , <i>confit de canard</i> , calves' liver and <i>entrecôte</i> . ^{[22]:30}
Bistrot à Vin		Similar to <i>cabarets</i> or <i>tavernes</i> of the past in France. Some offer inexpensive alcoholic drinks, while others take pride in offering a full range of vintage <u>AOC</u> wines. The food in some is simple, including sausages, ham and cheese, while others offer dishes similar to what can be found in a bistro. ^{[22]:30}
<u>Bouchon</u>		Found in <u>Lyon</u> , the <i>bouchons</i> produce traditional Lyonnaise cuisine, such as sausages, duck <i>pâté</i> or roast pork. The dishes can be quite fatty, and heavily oriented around meat. There are about twenty officially certified traditional bouchons, but a larger number of establishments describing themselves using the term. ^[67]
Brewery	<u>Brasserie</u>	These establishments were created in the 1870s, following the Franco-Prussian War of 1870 to 1871, by refugees from Alsace-Lorraine. These establishments serve beer, but most serve wines from Alsace such as <u>Riesling</u> , <u>Sylvaner</u> , and <u>Gewürztraminer</u> . The most popular dishes are <i>choucroute</i> and <u>seafood</u> dishes. ^{[22]:30} In general, a brasserie is open all day every day, offering the same menu. ^[68]
<u>Café</u>		Primarily locations for coffee and alcoholic drinks. Additional tables and chairs are usually set outside, and prices are usually higher for service at these tables. The limited foods sometimes offered include <i>croque-monsieur</i> , salads,



A bouchon, *Le tablier* (the apron), in Vieux Lyon



Café de Flore, in Paris



An *estaminet* in Lille

	<i>moules-frites</i> (mussels and <i>pommes frites</i>) when in season. <i>Cafés</i> often open early in the morning and shut down around nine at night. ^{[22]:30}
<u>Salon de Thé</u>	These locations are more similar to <i>cafés</i> in the rest of the world. These tearooms often offer a selection of cakes and do not offer alcoholic drinks. Many offer simple snacks, salads, and sandwiches. Teas, hot chocolate, and <i>chocolat à l'ancienne</i> (a popular chocolate drink) are offered as well. These locations often open just prior to noon for lunch and then close late afternoon. ^{[22]:30}
<u>Bar</u>	Based on the American style, many bars were built at the beginning of the 20th century (particularly around World War I, when young American expatriates were quite common in France, particularly in Paris). These locations serve cocktails, whiskey, <u>pastis</u> and other alcoholic drinks. ^{[22]:30}
<u>Estaminet</u>	Typical of the <u>Nord-Pas-de-Calais</u> region, <i>estaminets</i> (small bars/restaurants) used to be a central place for farmers, mine- or textile-workers to meet and socialize, sometimes the bars would be in a grocery store. ^[69] Customers could order basic regional dishes, play boules, or use the bar as a meeting place for clubs. ^[70] These estaminets almost disappeared, but are now considered a part of Nord-Pas-de-Calais history, and therefore preserved and promoted.

Restaurant staff

Larger restaurants and hotels in France employ extensive staff and are commonly referred to as either the *kitchen brigade* for the kitchen staff or *dining room brigade* system for the dining room staff. This system was created by Georges Auguste Escoffier. This structured team system delegates responsibilities to different individuals who specialize in certain tasks. The following is a list of positions held both in the kitchen and dining rooms brigades in France:^{[22]:32}

Staff

Section	French	English	Duty
Kitchen brigade	<u>Chef de cuisine</u>	Head chef	Responsible for overall management of kitchen. They supervise staff, and create menus and new recipes with the assistance of the restaurant manager, make purchases of raw food items, train apprentices and maintain a sanitary and hygienic environment for the preparation of food. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Sous-chef de cuisine</i>	Deputy Head chef	Receives orders directly from the <i>chef de cuisine</i> for the management of the kitchen and often represents the <i>chef de cuisine</i> when he or she is not present. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Chef de partie</i>	Senior chef	Responsible for managing a given station in the kitchen where they specialize in preparing particular dishes. Those that work in a lesser station are referred to as a <i>demi-chef</i> . ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Cuisinier</i>	Cook	This position is an independent one where they usually prepare specific dishes in a station. They may be referred to as a <i>cuisinier de partie</i> . ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Commis</i>	Junior cook	Also works in a specific station, but reports directly to the <i>chef de partie</i> and takes care of the tools for the station. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Apprenti(e)</i>	Apprentice	Many times they are students gaining theoretical and practical training in school and work experience in the kitchen. They perform preparatory or cleaning work. ^{[22]:30}
	<i>Plongeur</i>	Dishwasher	Cleans dishes and utensils and may be entrusted with basic preparatory jobs. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Marmiton</i>	Pot and pan washer	In larger restaurants, takes care of all the pots and pans instead of the <i>plongeur</i> . ^{[22]:33}
	<u>Saucier</u>	Saucemaker/sauté cook	Prepares sauces, warm <i>hors d'œuvres</i> , completes meat dishes and in smaller restaurants may work on fish dishes and prepare sautéed items. This is one of the most respected positions in the kitchen brigade. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Rôtisseur</i>	Roast cook	Manages a team of cooks that roasts, broils and deep fries dishes. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Grillardin</i>	Grill cook	In larger kitchens this person prepares the grilled foods instead of the <i>rôtisseur</i> . ^{[71]:8}
	<i>Friturier</i>	Fry cook	In larger kitchens this person prepares fried foods instead of the <i>rôtisseur</i> . ^[71]
	<i>Poissonnier</i>	Fish cook	Prepares fish and seafood dishes. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Entremetier</i>	Entrée preparer	Prepares soups and other dishes not involving meat or fish, including vegetable dishes and egg dishes. ^{[22]:32}
	<i>Potager</i>	Soup cook	In larger kitchens, this person reports to the <i>entremetier</i> and prepares the soups. ^[71]
	<i>Legumier</i>	Vegetable cook	In larger kitchen this person also reports to the <i>entremetier</i> and prepares the vegetable dishes. ^[71]
	<u>Garde manger</u>	Pantry supervisor	Responsible for preparation of cold <i>hors d'œuvres</i> , prepares salads, organizes large buffet displays and prepares <i>charcuterie</i> items. ^{[22]:30}

	<i>Tournant</i>	Spare hand/ roundsperson	Moves throughout kitchen assisting other positions in kitchen.
	<i>Pâtissier</i>	Pastry cook	Prepares desserts and other meal end sweets, and in locations without a <i>boulangier</i> also prepares breads and other baked items. They may also prepare pasta for the restaurant. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Confiseur</i>		Prepares candies and <i>petit fours</i> in larger restaurants instead of the <i>pâtissier</i> . ^[71]
	<i>Glacier</i>		Prepares frozen and cold desserts in larger restaurants instead of the <i>pâtissier</i> . ^[71]
	<i>Décorateur</i>		Prepares show pieces and specialty cakes in larger restaurants instead of the <i>pâtissier</i> . ^{[71]:8–9}
	<i>Boulangier</i>	Baker	Prepares bread, cakes and breakfast pastries in larger restaurants instead of the <i>pâtissier</i> . ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Boucher</i>	Butcher	Butchers meats, poultry and sometimes fish. May also be in charge of breeding meat and fish items. ^[71]
	<i>Aboyeur</i>	Announcer/ expediter	Takes orders from dining room and distributes them to the various stations. This position may also be performed by the <i>sous-chef de partie</i> . ^[71]
	<i>Communard</i>		Prepares the meal served to the restaurant staff. ^[71]
	<i>Garçon de cuisine</i>		Performs preparatory and auxiliary work for support in larger restaurants. ^{[22]:33}
Dining room brigade	<i>Directeur de la restauration</i>	General manager	Oversees economic and administrative duties for all food-related business in large hotels or similar facilities including multiple restaurants, bars, catering and other events. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Directeur de restaurant</i>	<u>Restaurant manager</u>	Responsible for the operation of the restaurant dining room, which includes managing, training, hiring and firing staff, and economic duties of such matters. In larger establishments there may be an assistant to this position who would replace this person in their absence. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Maître d'hôtel</i>		Welcomes guests, and seats them at tables. They also supervise the service staff. Commonly deals with complaints and verifies patrons' bills. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Chef de salle</i>		Commonly in charge of service for the full dining room in larger establishments; this position can be combined into the <i>maître d'hotel</i> position. ^[71]
	<i>Chef de rang</i>		The dining room is separated into sections called <i>rangs</i> . Each <i>rang</i> is supervised by this person to coordinate service with the kitchen. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Demi-chef de rang</i>	Back server	Clears plates between courses if there is no <i>commis débarrasseur</i> , fills water glasses and assists the <i>chef de rang</i> . ^[71]
	<i>commis de rang</i>		
	<i>Commis débarrasseur</i>		Clears plates between courses and the table at the end of the meal. ^{[22]:33}
	<i>Commis de suite</i>		In larger establishments, this person brings the different courses from the kitchen to the table. ^{[22]:33}

<i>Chef d'étage</i>	Captain	Explains the menu to the guest and answers any questions. This person often performs the tableside food preparations. This position may be combined with the <i>chef de rang</i> in smaller establishments. ^[71]
<i>Chef de vin</i>	Wine server	Manages wine cellar by purchasing and organizing as well as preparing the wine list. Also advises the guests on wine choices and serves the wine. ^{[22]:33}
<i>Sommelier</i>		
<i>chef sommelier</i>		In larger establishments, this person will manage a team of sommeliers. ^{[22]:33}
<i>chef caviste</i>		
<i>Serveur de restaurant</i>	Server	This position found in smaller establishments performs the multiple duties of various positions in the larger restaurants in the service of food and drink to the guests. ^{[22]:33}
<i>Responsable de bar</i>	Bar manager	Manages the bar in a restaurant, which includes ordering and creating drink menus; they also oversee the hiring, training and firing of barmen. Also manages multiple bars in a hotel or other similar establishment. ^{[22]:33}
<i>Chef de bar</i>		
<i>Barman</i>	Bartender	Serves alcoholic drinks to guests. ^{[22]:33}
<i>Dame du vestiaire</i>		Coat room attendant who receives and returns guests' coats and hats. ^{[22]:33}
<i>Voituriers</i>	Valet	Parks guests' cars and retrieves them when the guests leave. ^{[22]:33}

See also



- [Acadian cuisine](#)
- [Cajun cuisine](#)
- [Cuisine of Quebec](#)
- [French Americans](#)
- [French Canadians](#)
- [French paradox](#)
- [Lebanese cuisine](#)
- [Larousse Gastronomique](#)
- [Le Répertoire de la Cuisine](#)
- [List of French cheeses](#)
- [List of French desserts](#)
- [List of French dishes](#)
- [List of French restaurants](#)
- [List of French soups and stews](#)
- [List of restaurants in Paris](#)

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- Bryan Newman, "Behind the French Menu (<http://behind-the-french-menu.blogspot.com>)",

External links

- France stages first-ever Gastronomy Day (<http://www.english.rfi.fr/france/20110923-france-stages-first-ever-gastronomy-day>) Radio France Internationale in English

